

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 6
♥ Q 10 8 3
♦ J 9 6 2
♣ Q J 3

♠ A Q 10 2
♥ K 7
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ K 7 5



♠ 7 4
♥ 9 6 5
♦ A 10 8 4
♣ 10 9 8 2

♠ K J 8 5 3
♥ A J 4 2
♦ 5
♣ A 6 4

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

6♠ by North
win in your hand.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 2

Since the ♦ loser is a sure thing you will need to find somewhere to discard a ♣. There are three possibilities: Finesse East for the ♥Q. (50% chance) Try to drop the ♥Q by ruffing the third round. (also about 50%) Establish a ♦ honor. (100% certain)

First pull trumps, ending in dummy. It takes two rounds. Next play the ♦5 toward your ♦Q. East wins this and plays another ♣. Win the ♣, come to your hand with the ♥K, then play your good ♦Q, discarding dummy's losing ♣.

You will need to ruff two ♥s in your hand, but the rest of the tricks are yours.

This was pretty easy because the trumps split 2-2.

If they had been 3-1 you would have had to leave the last trump undrawn until after you had ruffed two ♥s in your hand.

Partner's 2♥ bid is a transfer; he expects you to bid 2♠. However, with such great ♠ support and an outside doubleton your hand now revalues to 18 points - more than an opening 1NT. You indicate this with a jump to 3♠. This is called a "Super-Accept". Partner now bids 4NT. What do you answer?

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Blackwood, and with one Ace you answer 5♦. Partner bids 6♠ and everybody passes.

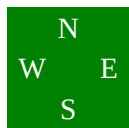
Obviously you aren't going to hold up on the ♣ lead. It won't matter where you take it, but assume you

Board 3

South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 8 5 3
♥ 6
♦ K Q J 9
♣ A 7 5 3

♠ A J 6
♥ Q J 9 7 5 2
♦ 6 4 2
♣ 8



♠ 10 9 7 2
♥ A 8
♦ 10 8 3
♣ 10 9 6 4

♠ K 4
♥ K 10 4 3
♦ A 7 5
♣ K Q J 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4

With 10 points and a 6-card ♥ suit you want to transfer. You say 2♦ and partner bids 2♥.

With 10 points and a 6-card ♥ suit you want to transfer. You say 2♦ and partner bids 2♥.

You know you want to play in ♥s since partner will have at least 2 of them. Your problem is whether to merely invite with 3♥ or go ahead and bid the game. Since partner has either 15, 16 or 17 points you should probably just bid 4♥. The worst thing that could happen is that partner would be playing game with only 25 points.

The contract would be 4♥ played by North.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♦K. Do you hold up or not?

There is no reason to hold up. Besides, you have bigger problems to deal with.

After you take the ♦A at trick one you have four fast losers staring you in the face the instant you lose the lead. So do you pull trumps now?

No, you dare not touch trumps yet - remember those 4 fast losers.

You cannot avoid the ♥A and ♣A, so you must get rid of one of the ♦ losers before you play trumps.

Win the ♦A, play the ♠K, then finesse the ♠J. If the finesse works discard a ♦ on the ♠A, then pull trumps. If the finesse fails you will go down 2 instead of 1.

You made it - on a 50% chance.

When the cards MUST lie in a particular way for the contract to be makeable, just assume that's the way they lie and go for it.